experiment and seek answers while the rest of us simply use the nearest electronic gadget to get the same answers. The former, unfortunately, need to use the scientific methodologies since they're exploring the fringes of the known world. While the rest of us can simply be done with a Google search. Technology, thus, gives us the answers. For everyone under the sun, technology enables instant gratification. That bothersome curiosity is instantly put to rest and we get an instant dose of dopamine. Who was the first president of India? Google has the answer. Who discovered the harmful effects of radioactive substances? Google knows. What's the nearest restaurant that can get you your favourite meal in the least possible time? Ask the Google God!

The speed at which technology gives us the answers we seek make it very similar to a drug. And with such a vast plethora of knowledge being accessible at our fingertips, we're getting an uncontrollable supply of the drug. Each and every gadget is akin to a drug peddler and given how pervasive technology is, it's ridiculously easy to get your fix these days. And once you do, a second dose is never far away. Not to mention countless other doses that follow.

Addicted to screens of all types

Owing a desktop PC gives you a humongous trove of information and abilities, a laptop allows you to take this to a lot more places that the desktop couldn't go, and then there's the humble smartphone which we even take with us to the loo!

Curiosity is a psychological trait, and there is a strong belief that psychological traits are subject to genetic transmission. In his book *Why?: What makes us curious*, Mario Livio argues the same. He mentions that the very fact that some people are inherently more curious as compared to others has largely to do with genetics. You can enhance this level of curiosity by encouraging people to ask more questions or you can suppress curiosity as we can see in certain cultures where religious doctrine trumps all.

Speaking of traits, personalities are broadly classified into two types, Type-A and Type-B. The former is more competitive, outgoing, ambition and aggressive while Type-B are more relaxed and easy going. Those with Type-A personalities find it a lot more difficult to fight this addiction and should they turn all gadgets off and move away, they fall into a state of exhaustion. Dr. Nerina Ramlakhan in an interview with BBC, says that such personalities, even when watching TV have multiple screens about. They portray a level of hyperactivity, driven by the fear of not being in control. And the lack of offline time causes hyper-arousal of the brain. So they remain in a state of distractibility. This leads to a lack of focus, decrease in memory and academic performance since they're not developing the part of the brain that deals with singular focus. Apparently, the upcoming generation or digital natives will have it much worse that we do.

Is it just humans?

Animals, for lack of being as intellectually capable as us, aren't truly addicted. However, the use of tools by animals for the purpose of acquiring something has been well documented. Primates have been observed to make use of rocks to crush nuts, use sticks for combat, use leaves for cover from the rain and stones for plugging holes. Crows have built a reputation for being intelligent, to the point that they've been observed dropping hard nuts on the roads for vehicles to run over. Thus, cracking them up so that the crows can feast upon its innards. And it's not just these vertebrates with a better developed nervous system but even invertebrates like the octopus have been known to retrieve, stack and build shelters out of coconut shells for themselves.

Animals also exhibit addiction patterns, Australian wallabies are known to seek out poppy plants and dogs are known to harass venomous toads to force them to release bufotenine, a compound which is hallucinogenic. There are many more such examples throughout the animal kingdom. It's because of such strong resemblance of addictive traits in animals that animal drug testing experiments exist. These models, though unethical in the books of animal activists, are accepted by the scientific community for its proven accuracy. Animals are known

Even animals aren't immune to tech addiction

to ape those who seem to be using tools as a manner of easing gratification, be it by obtaining food faster or to simply get high. This makes them very similar to us in terms of behavioural traits. While we cannot be certain whether an animal upon gaining our level of sentience might be prone to technology addiction, it certainly seems very plausible.

Time for your next fix

To summarise what we've learnt about technology addiction. It can be said that technology addiction is real, is omnipresent because it is so pervasive, and acts as an enabler and reels us by satisfying our instinctual curiosities, plus giving us a seemingly endless supply of dopamine. In the words of the immortal Rick James, "it's a hell of a drug". Of course, each and every one of you should take pride in the fact that you're seemingly bucking the trend. You're still reading books and magazines, and are firmly grounded. Most others are spending this same time aimlessly scrolling through their Feacebook feeds or watching pointless videos. Give yourself a pat on the back for that, but beware the addiction!